

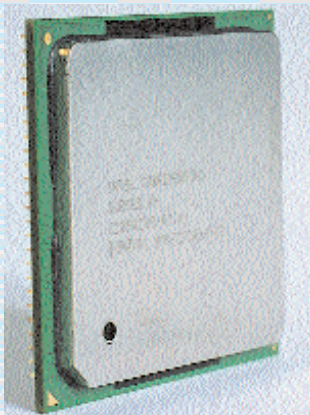
Bazaar

We test the latest and the best hardware and software available in the market

Intel Pentium 4 2.4 GHz

New speedster on the block

The latest revision of the Pentium 4, running at a truly impressive 2.4 GHz, has been launched. It uses the Northwood core with 55 million transistors and 512 KB of L2 cache. The processor scored some impressive benchmark results. We used Intel's D850MD board with 512 MB RDRAM, ATA 100 hard drive and a GeForce3 graphics card to test the processor. It produced the highest score ever recorded in *Quake III*—375.8 fps in normal mode. Its trailblazing



performance extended to Content Creation Winstone

2001—the processor helped the system touch the magic figure of 90.3 as against 86.1 that the 2.2 GHz processor had achieved on the same configuration. The other scores were equally impressive. The processor remained cool during the test and the rather large heatsink that Intel ships with this processor more than takes care of its temperature. Individuals working on high-end 3D

authoring software or those who employ tools for intensive non-linear video editing will be able to fully appreciate its true power. Gamers too will find this processor a worthy companion for their high-end graphics cards.

SPECIFICATIONS

0.13 micron die size, Socket 478, 512 KB L2 cache

Intel Pentium 4 2.4 GHz	A-
Performance	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★
Features	★★★★ ^{1/2}
OVERALL	★★★★

Price: Rs 35,000
Contact: Nebula Technologies
Phone: 022-6347159
E-mail: pankaj@nebulatech.com
Web site: www.intel.com

Acer Digital Camera 300

A good shot

This camera is ultra-slim and weighs a mere 78 grams. It measures 18.4 mm in thickness, so it can snugly fit into your pocket. It can store 90 to 95 images taken at a resolution of 640x480. There are six utilities bundled with the digi-cam—Mr. Photo, Image Folio, Video Works, It's Me (3D figure animation tool), Crazy Talk (face animation tool) and Microsoft NetMeeting. And of course, there are the drivers.

The camera took good quality images in a well-lit room and even objects placed at a distance were clear. The flash was kept on auto mode while taking the photographs.



The camera takes about 4 seconds to save the image in the memory, and until that is done, the busy light keeps blinking.

This camera can be used as a PC Web camera and a digital video camera (with a frame rate as high as 30 fps). The transfer of images from camera to PC through the USB interface was fast. The camera even has a cradle with a lock which helps in fixing it on a laptop. However, it can't be placed on top of the PC or monitor with the cradle attached. The installation of the drivers was an easy task and the manual is fairly descriptive. The cam-



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It's a sleek, slim and flauntable product—a good camera for personal use. The only drawback is its price. At Rs 9,000 it's way too expensive